Vopak

South Africa liquid fuels market outlook

Demand, supply and routes — implications for Vopak

Durban and Lesedi | Market-sizing framework

11 October 2026

Planning estimates and illustrative capture. Customer access and usable capacity remain to be established.

Photo source: Royal Vopak | Terminal Durban | vopak.com



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South Africa's large fuel market relies on substantial imports

21.0bn L

Estimated demand, 2025

8.9bn petrol and 12.1bn diesel

5.8bn L

Domestic production assumption

National planning baseline

16.7bn L

Gross import requirement

Broadly matches recorded imports

A substantial demand base

Road transport is the largest use. Mining, agriculture, manufacturing and power also contribute.

Demand has eased from 21.9bn litres in 2023 to an estimated 21.0bn in 2025.

Durban connects imports to inland customers

Durban customs recorded 13.16bn litres of imports in 2025. The Durban–Lesedi route provides access to inland demand, subject to customer and logistics access.

South Africa has an established import market serving a large national fuel requirement.

Department national sales; SARS 2025 trade; analytical workbook v02. 2025 demand is estimated; 5.8bn L production is a planning assumption. Gross import need includes exports and assumes no stock change.

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Changes in demand, domestic supply and import routes could reduce flows through Durban

Complication	Driver	What changes for fuel demand and Durban flows
1 Demand	Sector activity	Mining, manufacturing and agriculture drive equipment and freight demand along different growth paths.
	Eskom recovery	Reliable electricity reduces peaking and backup diesel at utilities, mines, factories and farms.
	Road-to-rail	Freight shifted from trucks reduces road diesel use; net savings depend on rail traction.
	Vehicle efficiency	Lower fuel consumption per kilometre reduces demand at a given level of road activity.
2 Domestic supply	Refinery output and restarts	Higher production displaces imports; outages or lower output increase import dependence.
3 Import routes	Ports and inland connections	Matola competes for inland supply. Assess Walvis Bay, pipeline access and delivered cost; Walvis Bay diversion is unquantified.

A large national import market does not automatically translate into growth for Vopak.

Stats SA sector activity and freight; Eskom Integrated Report 2025 p141; Sasol and Glencore production disclosures; Galp and Petromoc infrastructure disclosures. Detailed evidence: South Africa story v37 pp7–11.

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How the national fuel market translates into Vopak's addressable volume

Sizing step	Basis for the calculation	Market measure
1 **National demand**	Petrol and diesel by end use: road, mining, manufacturing, agriculture and power. Apply activity, rail and efficiency drivers.	21.0bn L in 2025 Estimated demand
2 **Import requirement**	Demand − domestic production + exports + stock build (or − stock draw).	16.7bn L in 2025 Gross import need
3 **Ports and inland routes**	Allocate imports across ports; assess pipeline, road and rail connections. Compare Durban with Matola and potential Walvis Bay routes.	Supply pool by catchment Route shares to establish
4 **Addressable market**	Size product and customer flows Durban and Lesedi can each serve, by catchment, logistics access and competing supply. Reconcile shared flows.	Addressable volume By site, product and customer
5 **Achievable capture**	Establish current Vopak throughput, volumes retained and additional customer volumes it can win. Assess competition and contracts; count shared fuel once.	Current + incremental capture By site and customer
6 **Capacity and investment**	Compare captured throughput with usable tanks, stock turns, receipt and dispatch capacity; identify the incremental constraint.	Capacity shortfall Basis for investment

Steps 4–5 size Vopak's opportunity: addressable customer flows, then achievable capture.

Framework: analytical workbook v02 and market-sizing workbook. Gateway shares and customer access require validation. Walvis Bay is a route to assess; no diversion volume is assigned. Stock build increases import need; stock draw reduces it.

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Substantial imports sustain the market, while customer capture determines Vopak's expansion

16.6bn L

2030 national imports

Base-case imports across all gateways. Activity growth broadly offsets power, rail and efficiency reductions; domestic production stays at 5.8bn litres.

2.63bn L

Illustrative Durban capture

Assumes 20% of Durban's 2025 import pool. Includes 1.32bn litres onward through Lesedi within the same fuel flow.

Illustrative share; no explicit deduction for Matola or Walvis Bay diversion.

Expansion follows secured incremental flow

The illustrative flow fits the preliminary working-tank calculation.

Secure additional customer volumes, establish usable capacity, and identify the constraint that investment would solve.

Invest where secured additional volumes create a demonstrated capacity shortfall.

Analytical workbook v02 base scenario; market-sizing workbook and working-capacity assessment. Capture is illustrative; Lesedi is included within Durban flow. Contracted share, product balance and usable capacity remain to be established.

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Thank you

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Discussion

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